Teacher Wu Kuan | Radicals, Once and for All — √9 vs x² = 9

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1. The trap question

Is √9 = ±3?

2. The method

• √9 = 3 (the radical is never negative).
• $x^2 = 9 \rightarrow x = \pm 3$ (the equation has two solutions).

3. Parent check method

Ask your child: “Is this a radical sign or an equation?” before writing ±.

Practice

1. √25
2. Solve $x^2 = 25$.
3. $-\sqrt{49}$
4. $\sqrt{((-3)^2)}$
5. Solve $x^2 = 2$.

Answers

1. 5
2. x = ±5
3. −7
4. 3
5. x = ±√2

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